

MASON REECE

☎ +1 (919) 805-9931 ✉ mpreece@mit.edu 🏠 Cambridge, MA

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology

2022 – Present

- PhD in Political Science, focus in American Politics and Models & Methods
- Dissertation: *Essays on Local Political Behavior using Cast Vote Records*
 - * Committee: Andrea Campbell, Devin Caughey, and Charles Stewart III (chair)

Rice University

2022

- BA in Political Science with Honors, BA in Social Policy Analysis, Minor in Data Science
- Distinction in Research and Creative Works, Phi Beta Kappa, cum laude

WRITTEN WORK

Publications

- *Cast Vote Records: A Database of Ballots from the 2020 U.S. Election*. 2024. Nature Scientific Data. (with Shiro Kuriwaki and 12 others; co-first author with Kuriwaki). Winner of [MIT's Prize for Open Data](#). Media [coverage](#).
- *Postal Voting in the 2020 Election*. Journal of Election Administration, Research and Practice. 2022. (with Lonna Atkeson, MV Hood III, Colin Jones, and Robert M Stein).

Working Papers

- *Even Faster Ideal Point Estimation: Using Variational Autoencoders to Estimate IRT Models*
- *Missed Opportunities: Uncontested Elections in Contested Places*
- *Partisan Elections and Partisan Voting: Evidence from Judicial Elections* (with Daniel M. Thompson)
- *Trends in Nationalization of State and Local Elections* (with Shigeo Hirano, Joseph Loffredo, and James M. Snyder Jr.)
- *Local community opposition to data centers is clear and growing* (with Adam Rauh and Tyler Simko)

TEACHING

[Kaufman Teaching Certificate](#), MIT Teaching + Learning Lab

2026

TA for Generalized Linear Modeling & Bayesian Inference (taught by In Song Kim)

2025

Designed and taught MIT Political Methodology Workshop: Cluster Computing

2023 & 2024

AWARDS AND DISTINCTIONS

MIT Political Methodology Lab Research Grant

2026

[MIT Prize for Open Data](#)

2024

[Sallyport Award](#), considered to be the top undergraduate award at Rice

2022

Judge Woodrow Seals Award for Community Service

2022

Rhodes, Marshall, and Truman Scholarship Finalist

2021-2022

Douglas S. Harlan Award, for demonstrated commitment to political involvement

2021

[Morty Rich Scholarship](#), for commitment and service to Rice and to the greater community

2021

Jesse Jones Leadership Summer in DC Internship Program	2020 & 2021
Social Policy Analysis Best Paper Award	2021
Rice University Trustee Distinguished Merit Scholarship	2018-2022

SELECTED TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

University of Michigan School of Information (2026); Political Methodology Conference (2026); State Politics & Policy Conference (2026); APSA Conference (2024, 2026); MIT American Politics Workshop (2025, 2026); ESRA Conference (2023-2025); SPSA Conference (2024); Rice University's Social Science Advisory Board (2021); Covid-19 & the Election: Understanding Voter Preferences and Intentions (2020); MPSA Conference (2020)

SERVICE

Mentorship Co-Chair, MIT Political Science Graduate Student Council (2025 & 2026)

SOFTWARE

[rcvr](#): Clean cast vote records of many types (creator)

OTHER EXPERIENCE

CBS News Election Data Desk 2024 –

- Co-created R/Python pipeline to scrape and analyze election night returns at the precinct-level in battleground states. Worked in real time to provide live election results for the 2024 and 2025 general elections. Collaborated with a diverse team of academics and news analysts. Implementing new machine learning and conformal inference for the 2026 elections.

Research Assistantships

- Assisted with various research projects for: Charles Stewart III (2023-2025); MIT Election Data + Science Lab (2023-2026); Devin Caughey (Summer 2025); Political Methodology Lab (Fall 2024); Robert M. Stein and Elizabeth Vann (2019-2022); Chris Edelson (Summer 2020); A.Kadir Yildirim (2019-2020); Melissa Marschall (2019).

Center for Election Innovation and Research Summer 2021

Head Poll Worker in Cambridge 2022-2024

Head Poll Worker at the Rice Polling Location 2020-2022